

DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2025-26
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: X
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER II [SET A]

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

***Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.
You will not be allowed to write during the first 15 minutes.
This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.
The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.***

The paper has four sections.

Section A is compulsory- All questions in Section A must be answered.

You must attempt one question from each of the Sections B, C and D and one other question from any section of your choice.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of six printed pages.

SECTION A

(Attempt all questions from this section)

Question 1

Read the following questions and choose the most appropriate response from the choices given below. (Please do not copy the question – simply write out in correct serial order the appropriate word or phrase.) [16]

- i) Select the option that shows the correct relationship between statements (1) and (2) from Maya Angelou's poem *When Great Trees Fall*.
Statement 1: Great souls die and our reality, bound to them, takes leave of us.
Statement 2: When great trees die, the air around us becomes light and rare.
- a) (1) is true and (2) is false
 - b) (2) is true and (1) is false
 - c) Both (1) and (2) are true
 - d) (2) is an example of (1)
- ii) The bridge that connects the human world and the spirit world in H.W. Longfellow's poem *The Haunted Houses* is _____.
- a) broken and unstable
 - b) secured and unstable
 - c) stable and clear
 - d) shaking and unstable
- iii) The character of King Francis in Leigh Hunt's *The Glove and the Lions* can be best described as-
- a) just and hearty
 - b) shrewd and vengeful
 - c) ambitious and hearty
 - d) dominating and just

- iv) The poet, Leigh Hunt, in his poem *The Glove and the Lions* describes Count de Lorge's beloved as-
- | | |
|-------------------------|--------------------------|
| a) gentle and beautiful | b) wealthy and lively |
| c) lively and beautiful | d) beautiful and wealthy |
- v) H.W. Longfellow's poem, *The Haunted Houses* talks about a journey of achieving _____ in life.
- | | |
|-----------------|--------------|
| a) equivocation | b) equipoise |
| c) equanimity | d) equality |
- vi) To which genre does William Sleator's short story, *The Elevator* belong?
- | | |
|---------------------|-------------------|
| a) Science fiction | b) Fairy tale |
| c) Humorous fiction | d) Horror fiction |
- vii) Choose the option that lists the sequence of events from William Sleator's short story *The Elevator* in the correct order.
1. At least his father was with him in the elevator.
 2. Martin started running down the stairs.
 3. Father reached out and pressed number nine.
 4. His father was silent on the way to the hospital.
- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| a) 1, 2, 3, 4 | b) 3, 4, 2, 1 |
| c) 2, 4, 1, 3 | d) 1, 4, 3, 2 |
- viii) In Stephen Leacock's *With the Photographer*, how was the narrator received by the photographer when he first went to meet him?
- | | |
|--------------------|----------------------|
| a) with pleasure | b) with indifference |
| c) with excitement | d) with apprehension |
- ix) Which of this is NOT a character trait of the photographer? (*With the Photographer*)
- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| a) perfectionist | b) insensitive |
| c) stereotypical | d) punctual |
- x) What did the older women wear in Adjoa's village as mentioned in Ama Ata Aidoo's *The Girl Who Can*?
- | | |
|---------------------|----------------------|
| a) long frock coats | b) long wrap-arounds |
| c) long gowns | d) long socks |
- xi) *Caesar: Hence! Wilt thou lift up Olympus!* (Act 3 scene 1)
What was Olympus?
- | | |
|-----------------------|-------------------------------|
| a) statue Jewish God | b) statue of Brutus' ancestor |
| c) a mountain in Eden | d) a mountain in Greece |
- xii) Where did Brutus and Cassius set up their rebel camp? (Act 4 scene 2)
- | | |
|-------------|------------|
| a) Philippi | b) Sardis |
| c) Venice | d) Belmont |

- xiii) Octavius sends his servant to Antony to inform about his arrival in Rome. How far was he from Rome at the time when the servant came? (Act 3 scene 1)
- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| a) two leagues | b) ten leagues |
| c) seven leagues | d) twenty leagues |
- xiv) Which of the given options contains the figure of speech that appears in the following line from *Julius Caesar*, Act 3?
- I spurn thee like a cur out of my way.*
- | |
|--|
| a) Her smile was as bright as the sun, warming his soul. |
| b) He that cuts off twenty years of life, cuts off so many years of fearing death. |
| c) Our arms in strength of malice. |
| d) Her voice was a warm hug on a cold winter morning. |
- xv) ‘O Antony, beg not your death of us’. Who is the speaker? (Act 3 scene 1)
- | | |
|-----------|------------|
| a) Casca | b) Cassius |
| c) Brutus | d) Cicero |
- xvi) Mark Antony says, ‘My credit now stands on slippery ground...’ What does he mean by ‘credit’? (Act 3 scene 1)
- | | |
|-------------|-----------------|
| a) strength | b) reputation |
| c) loyalty | d) intelligence |

SECTION B
DRAMA (Julius Caesar- Shakespeare)

Question 2

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

*Antony: But yesterday the word of Caesar might
Have stood against the world; now lies he there,
And none so poor to do him reverence.
O masters!*

- i) Where is the scene taking place? Who is Mark Antony speaking to? What mental state is the speaker in? [3]
- ii) Who does Antony refer to as the ‘honourable men’ in his speech? What conditions were given to Antony before he could speak? [3]
- iii) What instances did Antony give to show that Caesar was not ambitious? [3]
- iv) What does Antony show while holding Caesar’s mantle? When had Caesar first put it? Explain ‘But yesterday the word of Caesar might/ Have stood against the world’ from the extract. [3]
- v) What had Caesar left for the Romans in his will? What impression do you form of Antony’s character after reading this scene? Give textual justification to support your answer. [4]

Question 3

Read the extract below and answer the questions that follow:

Antony: *This is a slight unmeritable man,
Meet to be sent in errands. Is it fit,
The three-fold world divided, he should stand
One of the three to share it?*

- i) Where is the scene taking place? Who is Antony speaking to? Who is the ‘unmeritable man’ being referred to? [3]
- ii) What was being discussed among Antony, the listener and the ‘unmeritable man’ just before this extract? What had Antony asked the ‘unmeritable man’ to bring? What would he do with it? [3]
- iii) How does Antony describe the ‘unmeritable man’ just after this extract? Why does he describe him in that manner? What does this attitude reveal about Antony’s character? [3]
- iv) Later in the scene Antony compares the ‘unmeritable man’ with his horse. Explain the comparison made. What important information does Antony give about Brutus and Cassius? [3]
- v) How does the listener describe the ‘unmeritable man’ ? What do you understand about the listener’s character after reading this scene? Where do they decide to go after this discussion? What advice does Antony give to the listener regarding fighting the battle? [4]

SECTION C

PROSE- SHORT STORIES

(Treasure Chest- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 4

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

Like all this business to do with my legs. I have always wanted to tell them not to worry. I mean Nana and my mother. That it did not have to be an issue for my two favourite people to fight over. But I didn’t want either to be told not to repeat that or it to be considered so funny that anyone would laugh at me until they cried.

- i) Who is being referred to as ‘I’? Where did ‘I’ live? Who does ‘I’ refer to as ‘Nana’? [3]
- ii) What was the ‘issue’ with the speaker’s legs? According to Nana, what kind of legs are appropriate for a woman and why? [3]
- iii) What was Nana’s idea about school? What does this tell you about Nana’s character? Why did the speaker’s mother want her to go to school? [3]
- iv) What important decision had the speaker’s teachers taken for her? How did Nana react to this decision? Later in the story, what did Nana do with the speaker’s uniform? [3]
- v) ‘I have always wanted to tell them not to worry.’ How did the speaker finally prove to ‘them’ that there was nothing to worry about her legs? How did Nana’s perception about legs change by the end of the story? How did her attitude change towards ‘I’? What is the message that the text conveys to its readers? [4]

Question 5

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

She did nothing. She only watched him, breathing loudly, until the elevator reached the first floor at last. Martin wanted to run past her to get out, but there was no room. He could only wait as she turned and moved slowly out into the lobby. Then he ran.

- i) Who is being referred to as 'she'? How old was Martin? How did the author describe him? [3]
- ii) Describe the elevator that Martin and 'she' were in. What was Martin's fear regarding the elevator? [3]
- iii) What alternative method did Martin take to reach to his destination? What was the problem with this alternative option? What had happened to Martin when he tried using this alternative method one morning? [3]
- iv) Comment on the relationship that Martin shared with his father. Give two textual instances to support your answer. [3]
- v) Elaborate the theme of the text with suitable explanation. Give an alternative title to the story and justify it. [4]

SECTION D

POETRY

(Treasure Chest- A Collection of ICSE Poems and Short Stories)

Question 6

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*When great souls die,
The air around us becomes
light, rare, sterile.
We breathe, briefly.*

- i) What impact does falling of a great tree have on rocks, lions and elephants? [3]
- ii) How does the falling of a great tree affect the small things in the forest? What happens to their senses as an impact? Why does the poet compare the falling of great trees with the death of great souls? [3]
- iii) Who are the 'great souls' of our lives? What happens to the air around us when they die? [3]
- iv) What does the poet say about our memory when we experience the death of a great soul? Why do our souls shrink when a great soul dies? [3]
- v) What happens when time passes after the death of a great soul? What happens to our senses then? Mention the theme of the poem with suitable justification. [4]

Question 7

Read the extract and answer the questions that follow:

*There are more guests at table than the hosts
Invited; the illuminated hall
Is thronged with quiet, inoffensive ghosts,
As silent as the pictures on the wall.*

- i) Who are referred to as the uninvited ‘guests’ at table? How has the poet described the nature of these ‘guests’? Mention the figure of speech that you find in this extract. [3]**
- ii) Where else can one meet these ‘guests’? How do they move about? [3]**
- iii) What is the difference between the perception of the speaker and the stranger at the fireside? Give the meaning of the word ‘illuminated’. [3]**
- iv) Why do the previous occupants of the houses stretch their dusty hands? Describe the floor of the bridge that descends from the world of spirits to connect with our world. Where do our thoughts wander? [3]**
- v) In this poem, the poet has given an unusual treatment to the theme of horror and supernatural. Comment on the statement with suitable justification. Also, provide an alternative title to the poem and justify your choice. [4]**